

Rep. Tom Emmer on the Jon Justice Show

Broadcast: August 25, 2026 • Duration: 11:51

JOHN:

Welcome to the show, and we finally got him, Representative Tom Emmer. I'm so sorry for the technical problems this morning, but it's great to see you this morning, my friend.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Good to see you, John. I was like, okay, so the MacBook's not working, the iPad's not working, the phone's not working, the congressman is working. Okay, we got it.

JOHN:

We made it work, and thank you so much, because I got a number of things that I want to talk about with you this morning. First off, let's start about the big news yesterday coming out of the Supreme Court, ruling partly on President Donald Trump's executive orders regarding mail-in ballots. It was funny, Tom, I know you'll appreciate this. The initial response was, Supreme Court gives Trump initial victory on voter integrity, but what are your thoughts on what the Supreme Court ruled, and does this bode well for the rest of President Trump's executive order that they have not ruled on yet?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Open his computer for us. Yeah, it's the decision people should know. Issues in executive order, obviously election integrity is one of the number one issues in this country. By the way, across party lines, Republicans, Democrats, others, it's like an 80% issue. Everybody wants their elections to be fair, transparent, and honest, okay? He's like a dog on a bone with this stuff. He is not letting it go. He wants it to be done during his term. So what does he do? On mail-in ballots, he signs an executive order months ago, at the beginning of his term almost. And what happens? You got 23 states, including ours, with Keith Ellison, the crooked attorney general that we have, and the Trump-hating attorney general, sues the Supreme Court, and the Supreme Court, and the Supreme Court, and the Trump-hating attorney general, sues the federal government, saying they can't do this. And what are they doing? They're saying that you should put together a list of people who are actually eligible for mail-in ballots, and you should maintain it. And the federal government should be able to check your homework, okay, John? What they did yesterday is the Supreme Court said to Keith Ellison and his Trump-hating colleagues, nope, this is too, it's premature, not right. Trump can continue to work on his executive order, his administration can. This is not ready for prime time, go away. And guess what? Guess what? Trump is going to continue it, but this is why our Senate has got to get off their rear ends and pass the Save America Act, John.

JOHN:

Yep, yep. Say it back. Yeah, something that you and I have talked about quite a bit, and I know that our audience feels the same way. Let's move over. Again, I got a number of issues to talk to you about. Before we get to Governor, I call him Governor Dimwalls, Tom, before we get to Governor Dimwalls and his executive

order on mining up in the boundary waters, I don't think, well, you and I haven't had a chance to talk since the primary. So I'm curious your thoughts on the primary results and the slate of candidates that the Republicans have chosen to run in November here in Minnesota.

REP. TOM EMMER:

I think the people have spoken, John, and overwhelmingly. So if a listener to your program, John, is saying, yeah, but my candidate didn't get through the primary, and maybe that was the endorsed candidate, right? Okay, I hear what you're saying, but they didn't. And now we have the people's choices. All of Minnesota had a chance to weigh in, all Minnesota Republicans. You had about 400,000 turnout, John. I think Lisa Damuth is a great pick. And I think Lisa Damuth and her running mate are going to give Amy Klobuchar fits. As Jackie Emmer said to me, this is the biggest nightmare that Amy Klobuchar could have ever expected. Michelle Tafoya, we've got a real candidate. This is a candidate that is attracting national attention. Again, the other people in that race, I like them all. I don't have an issue. When the people spoke, they chose Michelle. Michelle is raising the money. And you know what, John? Michelle's candidacy may bring a ton of outside investment into Minnesota, because I think with Peggy Flanagan on the other side, that nutbag, I think you're going to see this get national attention. You're going to have a Minnesota Senate seat on the map for the first time probably since Coleman and Franken, more than a decade ago. So I like the slate. It is the people that were chosen. You know what? We need to get behind all of them, because I believe they can win.

JOHN:

Were you in DC over the weekend for the IndyCar race? Were you near the event, or were you watching from afar? Because it was impressive. We talked about the past few days, and it was an amazing, amazing event. But I was curious if you were in DC at the time.

REP. TOM EMMER:

No, it was amazing. And this one, I literally had to sit out, right? I'm up on my feet again and moving. I've got, with the assistance of crutches, I can walk. Hopefully in the next week or two, I'll get rid of the crutches, and we'll be back in full motion. But I took the time to actually stay off my feet. And I was smiling, because I had to do this wheelchair for a little while. Yeah, I should have been there for the race, man. I was getting really fast in that thing. What a race, though. Even the Trump haters, I hope they understand what a great thing for the District of Columbia. They should keep that going every year.

JOHN:

Yeah, no, I completely agree. I completely agree. And also, speaking of agreeing, you have Grant Hochschild. He has an editorial in the Star Tribune. I'm a rural Democrat, he writes. Here's why I disagree with Walls and his executive order on mining. I have a separate story here, Representative Tom Emmer. Walls' executive order to restrict mining near boundary waters faces bipartisan backlash. Before I get your view on what, again, my words, Dim Walls did here with this, I'm curious. What do you think his motivation was? Was this to take it off the table for Amy Klobuchar? Was he appealing to special interest groups? It just seems like a very bizarre, unpopular move from a lame duck governor, even for Governor Dim Walls. Why do you think he did this?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, first off, you brought up the worst newspaper. John, there are better ways to hurt yourself. Stop reading that stupid thing.

JOHN:

Other people do, though, Tom. Other people do. I'm here to counter that nonsense.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Think about it. There's 5.7 million people in this state. Less than 200,000 even look at that piece of garbage. And you know what? It's going to get smaller and smaller. Within the next four or five years, if they're still alive, and I hope they're not, they're going to have about 30,000 people max reading that worthless political rag. But when it comes to your question, I call him the lame duck loser. This was spiteful, John. Spiteful, that's all it is. Think about this. Tina Smith and Peggy Flanagan engineered this whole thing to put Peggy Flanagan in position to replace her friend, Tina Smith. I don't think people recognize that those two had dinner the night before the announcement. When Tina made the announcement the next day at midday, within minutes, Peggy Flanagan's announcement, I'm running, was out there. They circled the wagons around Peggy Flanagan, they being the new Marxist socialist anarchist party of America here in Minnesota, circled the wagons around this Minneapolis extremist within hours. And guess why they did it, John? They did it because they don't like Tim Walz. And they didn't want Tim Walz to think that he would be the heir apparent. Then Tim said he was going to run for governor and it's so corrupt and he's so incompetent, he couldn't even do that. So they made him get out of the way for Amy Klobuchar. So why do you think he did it, John? He's a spiteful little baby who has nowhere to go. He's not competent to run a buffet, okay? This guy shouldn't be in charge of anything. And so what does he do? He goes after the Boundary Waters and now puts the Democrat candidates like Amy Klobuchar in the worst, not only is it a stupid decision because it goes against all the science, it actually empowers the Communist Party of China. Oh, well, maybe that's it. His friends over in Asia, but I think it's just spite. He did it out of spite to put Amy in a bad place and everybody else.

JOHN:

Well, it expires 90 days after he leaves office. What do you think the future of the order is going to be? And especially with this, there's bipartisan backlash on this. So what do you think the inevitable end of this order will be once Walz is out of office?

REP. TOM EMMER:

I don't think, I think it's done. I mean, look, the Obama administration did this to Rick Nolan, a mining-friendly Democrat in Northern Minnesota. They did it to him two hours before they left office. They didn't even tell him they were gonna try and shut it down. It took us working with President. Trump. Company called, even though they didn't go as far, I would, Trump opened it up again, and here we go. This is the Minneapolis liberals, left-wing nutbags that don't believe you and I should ever be able to go in and cut a tree down. It's these people who are telling all of Northern Minnesota, by the way, a huge number of working men and women, union jobs that they claim they support, they're telling them your way of life is no good. It's not gonna survive, John. And today's mining is, we have the most strict, stringent environmental laws in the world, and Minnesota even aspires for greater. So the idea that we would ever let mining harm the boundary waters is ludicrous. And I would just add, go up to Northern Minnesota, if you're not familiar with mining, look at what is left after the iron ore mining that took place for decades leading into the 70s. John, where they carved out the earth, it filled with water. You now have lakes with some of the cleanest water in the world. So it's a ridiculous order. When it goes away, just like Tim Walz, we'll never remember it.

JOHN:

Representative Tom Emmer, continue good luck in your recovery. I'm glad everything went well. You clearly need to get back on your feet because you got a lot of energy to get out there. There's no doubt about that. So thank you for weathering the technical problems that we experienced this morning, but it was great to hear from

you. Glad that we got you on. And I look forward to hopefully talking with you again next week.

REP. TOM EMMER:

I hope so too. And we'll have a little more time. Thank you.

JOHN:

Thank you so much. Great to speak with you this morning. Again, Representative Tom Emmer here on the show. Always great to... Always great.

This transcript was independently produced by MN-06 Watch for accountability and archival purposes.

Source: (August 25, 2026)

Archived: August 31, 2026

Source URL: <https://youtu.be/XUcJUSNHH7o>

For questions or corrections: mn06watch@gmail.com